

Software Access Guide

Northgate Group — IT Service Desk Manual | Version 3.1 | Effective 1 January 2026 | Owner: IT Operations

1. Scope

This guide explains how to request access to software that is not part of the standard build, how the approval workflow operates, how licences are allocated and reclaimed, and how to install approved applications. Hardware faults are covered by the Laptop Issue Guide.

2. Standard Software List

The following applications are included in the standard build and are installed on every company laptop. No request is needed to use them.

- Operating system, browser and the endpoint security agent.
- Office productivity suite, including the mail client and the spreadsheet application.
- Corporate messaging and video conferencing client.
- VPN client and the multi-factor authentication application.
- PDF reader, file archiver and the company portal self-service application.

3. Requesting New Software

Raise an IT ticket with the request type Software Issue and enter the application in the software name field. Use the full product name and edition, for example the professional edition rather than a general product family name, since editions differ in price and approval route.

The description must state the business reason, how often the application will be used, and whether an existing standard application has been considered and ruled out. Requests without a business reason are returned to the requester and the approval clock resets. If the request is to renew or reassign an existing licence rather than to buy a new one, state that explicitly, as renewals follow a shorter route.

4. Approval Workflow

- Step one: the line manager confirms the business need. Target two business days.
- Step two: IT Operations checks the application against the approved software register, and reviews security and compatibility. Target two business days.
- Step three: the licence budget owner in the requesting department approves the cost where a paid licence is required. Target three business days.
- Step four: IT Operations allocates the licence and the ticket moves to resolved once installation is confirmed.

Applications already on the approved register with a free licence pool skip step three and are usually available within one business day. Applications not on the register require a security review, which adds five to ten business days and may require a vendor assessment.

5. Installation Instructions

Approved applications are published to the Company Portal self-service catalogue and are installed by the employee without administrator rights. Open the Company Portal, search for the application by name, select install, and leave the device powered on and connected to the network until the installation completes.

If the application does not appear in the catalogue within one business day of the ticket being resolved, restart the device to force a policy refresh before commenting on the ticket. Installations that fail repeatedly are usually caused by insufficient disk space or by a pending operating system update.

6. Licence Policy

Licences are allocated to a named user and must not be shared between employees. Reassigning a licence requires a new ticket referencing the original.

- Paid licences are reclaimed automatically after 60 consecutive days without use.
- An employee whose licence is reclaimed may request it again, and reinstatement is normally granted within one business day.
- Licences are released automatically when an employee leaves the company or transfers to another department.
- Annual licence renewals are confirmed with the budget owner each October for the following year.

7. Unapproved Software and Administrator Rights

Employees must not install software obtained from outside the Company Portal, including free or trial applications and browser extensions that request access to page data. Unapproved software is removed automatically by the endpoint security agent and repeated attempts are reported to IT Operations.

Local administrator rights are granted only for a specific, time-limited engineering need, require department head approval, and expire automatically after 30 days.